

Chicago Tribune



\$4.00 | FRIDAY, JUNE 12, 2026 | CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Medical-aid-in-dying law faces lawsuit

Disabled patients, doctor, others allege the state’s legislation ends ‘ethical obligation to do no harm’

By **Jeremy Gorner**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A federal lawsuit filed Thursday challenges a new Illinois law set to go into effect in September that would allow doctors to prescribe medication to terminally ill people to end their own lives.

Two disabled patients, a doctor and various disability and patients’

rights organizations allege in the lawsuit that the state’s controversial End of Life Options Act “upends millennia of protections for Illinois patients in their relationships with their doctors by ending the ethical obligation to do no harm.”

The suit names Democratic Gov. JB. Pritzker, the Illinois Department of Public Health and its director, Dr. Sameer Vohra, as defendants.

It alleges the law violates federal laws, including the Americans with Disabilities Act, which protects people with disabilities from discrimination, and the Affordable Care Act, which is designed to help manage healthcare costs. The suit also alleges the new law violates the plaintiffs’ equal protection rights under the 14th Amendment.

A similar lawsuit filed Thursday targets New York state officials, including Democratic Gov. Kathy Hochul, as that state’s medical-aid-in-dying law takes effect in August.

The Illinois suit contends the End of Life Options Act, or EOLA, changes the legal foundation of every doctor-patient relationship, eliminating patients’ “historic legal right” to hold caregivers to a do-no-harm-obligation and replacing it with a standard permitting doctors to prescribe lethal drugs to help patients die by suicide.

“EOLA embarks on this reckless experiment with no guardrails and no adequate legal framework to prevent the erroneous taking of life,” the suit alleges. “Without any such

safeguards, or objective parameters for eligibility, there will be an inevitable evolution from EOLA’s ‘right to die’ to a ‘duty to die’ for individuals whose disabilities are a costly burden or who lack the resources for extended medical care.”

The lawsuit also claims that people with life-threatening disabilities, “as a discrete class,” will be highly vulnerable to pressure from insurers, hospitals and doctors to consent to ending their lives prema-

See **LAWSUIT** on Page A2



ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Storms displace residents

Edwin Rangel and Colleen Straight remove personal items Thursday as they walk past roofing debris following storms the previous day at an apartment building on Pershing Road and Ridgeland Avenue in Stickney. The married couple and their baby will stay with family in Indiana. Weather officials warned of more severe weather with the entire region under a tornado watch Thursday. **Page A9**

Trump picks new chief of intelligence after revolt

Federal prosecutor in New York named after opposition to Pulte

By **Collin Binkley,**
Larry Neumeister
and **Michael R. Sisak**
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump said Thursday that he plans to nominate Jay Clayton, the U.S. attorney for the Southern District of New York and a former Securities and Exchange Commission chairman, as director of national intelligence.

Trump announced the nomination on social media amid pressure from Congress to name a permanent replacement for Tulsi Gabbard, who resigned last month. Trump faced intense pushback over his decision to name Bill Pulte, head of the Federal Housing Finance Agency, as acting director. The job oversees the coordination of 18 intelligence agencies.

Later on Thursday, Trump said he still plans to put Pulte in the role “for a little while.” Speaking to reporters in the Oval Office, Trump called Clayton an “incredible talent” and said, “nobody has better credentials.”

The situation has led to a stand-off in Congress after Democrats

See **CLAYTON** on Page A2



GOING ‘PHONE-FREE’

Young people search for new ways to cut back on screen time

By **Audrey Pachuta**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

There’s something addictive about it. Sitting in bed late at night watching one 30-second clip after another. Bright, blue light illuminating the room.

Whipping out a camera the moment a restaurant server brings a meal or a favorite performer appears onstage. Succumbing to the urge to scroll Instagram the second conversation grows quiet or social awkwardness creeps in.

The alarm bells began to ring in recent Loyola University graduate Kamryn McPhaul’s head when she

Above: Kamryn McPhaul, 22, browses inside Women & Children First bookstore in Andersonville on May, 31. McPhaul has been limiting herself to an hour a day of phone usage since February and is spending more time exploring on solo trips or with friends. **JOSH BOLAND/TRIBUNE**

realized a third of her waking life was spent on her cellphone.

She, like so many others, craved the “cheap hits of dopamine,” the sense of mindless joy she received from watching a short video only to forget it moments later.

Earlier this year, she decided enough was enough.

Goodbye to Instagram and Snapchat; hello to sightseeing adventures, solo trips to the movies and hours spent at the Art Institute. The moment McPhaul installed a “permanent black-and-white filter” on her screen and deleted all her

See **PHONE** on Page A4

State moves to protect patients from abuse

Legislation tightens reporting requirements about misconduct

By **Emily Hoerner**
and **Lisa Schencker**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

State oversight failures exposed in a Tribune investigation drove a package of major changes to state law aimed at better protecting patients from sexual abuse or other inappropriate conduct by doctors, nurses and other healthcare workers.

State Rep. Kelly Cassidy, D-Chicago, who first proposed the legislation more than a year ago, called the final version of the bill, which the legislature approved late last session, “frankly revolutionary.”

The bill creates an obligation for healthcare businesses and individual healthcare workers to promptly report to the state if they witness or hear about allegations of sexual or intimate conduct involving healthcare professionals and patients. The state would be able to discipline licensed workers ranging from doctors and nurses to dentists and massage therapists for failing to report such incidents.

The bill also expands on previous reporting requirements for hospitals and allows the state to fine them for failing to properly report incidents where healthcare workers engaged in sexual or intimate conduct with patients. That money would go into the Sexual Assault Services and Prevention Fund. “Reckless failure to report” such incidents would also put healthcare organizations’ certificate to operate in jeopardy.

In addition, some healthcare workers — including doctors, midwives, nurses and physical therapists — could be disciplined if they conduct sensitive physical examinations alone after a patient requests that a third party be present, assuming the situation is not an emergency.

“Really, the teeth matter to me

See **PROTECT** on Page A5

INSIDE

President calls off next strikes on Iran

President Donald Trump said he has called off new military strikes on Iran, hours after threatening to escalate the war by seizing control of the country’s oil industry. He has said many times recently that the countries are close to a deal. **Nation & World, Page B4**

King’s connection with Bulls fans



How Stacey King — always “the life of the party” — breathed new life into Bulls fandom. **Sports**

SUBSCRIPTION

Visit myaccount.chicagotribune.com or call 312-546-7900 to sign up for a subscription. To place an ad, visit placeanad.chicagotribune.com.

WEATHER FORECAST

TODAY H: 81 L: 64
SAT. H: 87 L: 61
SUN. H: 72 L: 57
Complete details on Page A12

INDEX

Almanac A9
Comics D6-D7
Crossword D7
Editorials A6
Horoscope D6
Nation & World B4
Obituaries A9
Sudoku D7
Television D5

179th year No. 163
© Chicago Tribune



7 49485 00001 2